

MAC County Courier - May 29, 2026

From David Owen <dowen@mocounties.com>

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To Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>



The County Courier

May 29, 2026

Data Center Summit registration is open

The Missouri Association of Counties, along with the Missouri Municipal League and Missouri School Boards Association, is hosting a Data Center Summit on June 17 at Capital Bluffs Event Center in Jefferson City.

Seats are limited so register for the event

SAVE THE DATE

**DATA CENTER
SUMMIT**

June 17, 2026

**Capital Bluffs Center
Jefferson City, Missouri**

**Attendees must be members of
MML, MAC or MSBA.*

Presented by:

Missouri Local Leaders Partnership



This event will cover:

- Understanding Data Center Requirements
- Utilities and Energy
- Impacts on Local Government
- Legislation and Legal Considerations

**Watch for registration details from your local government organization.
We look forward to seeing you!**

Deadline May 31: Get your steering committee application in now

The deadline to submit your application for a presidential appointment to one of the MAC's steering committees for the 2026-2027 term is this weekend.

Get your application in now!

To be considered for an appointment, you will need to complete an application form and return it by **May 31, 2026**. Applications can be emailed to info@mocounties.com.

If you are appointed to a steering committee, in-person meetings will be held on Aug. 11 as part of MAC's Summer Board retreat at Camden on the Lake. Appointments are expected to be announced in the middle of June. Committee terms run from July 1-June 30.

The application can be found on the association's web page



Missouri News

Missouri governor places tax overhaul, initiative petition limits on August ballot

Gov. Mike Kehoe will ask Missouri voters in August to decide whether lawmakers should have new power to expand sales taxes to replace the income tax and whether citizen-led constitutional amendments should face a higher bar for passage.



Kehoe moved four proposed constitutional amendments to the Aug. 4 primary ballot: Amendment 1, renewing a sales tax for state parks and soil conservation; Amendment 2, requiring direct election of county assessors; Amendment 4, changing the threshold for constitutional amendments proposed by initiative petition; and Amendment 5, authorizing lawmakers to expand sales taxes as part of an effort to eliminate the state income tax.

In a statement Friday, Kehoe defended the August timing on Amendment 5 by pointing to the work lawmakers would face if it passes.

"Modernizing Missouri's outdated tax code, specifically, will be a momentous task for the Missouri General Assembly, and placing the measure to phase out Missouri's income tax on the August ballot gives lawmakers additional time to prepare for the next phase of implementation," Kehoe said. [Read more](#)

What you need to know about the Missouri Legislature's bills passed, not passed this session

Another chapter of the Missouri Legislature has closed. State lawmakers have completed the second session of the 103rd General Assembly in Jefferson City. [Read more](#)

Missouri bill aims to make it easier to dismiss lawsuits that punish public criticism

A Missouri bill awaiting action from Gov. Mike Kehoe would give judges broader power to quickly dismiss lawsuits designed to chill speech, replacing what supporters have long described as among the weakest anti-SLAPP laws in the country. [Read more](#)

No plans to suspend Missouri gas tax, governor signals

Despite concerns over rising fuel prices, Missouri does not have any plans to suspend the state's gas tax, according to the governor's office. [Read more](#)

Missouri Supreme Court rejects challenge to governor's power to call special sessions

The Missouri Supreme Court on Wednesday upheld a governor's power to call lawmakers into a special session at any time, ending the last lawsuit intended to overturn the state's newly gerrymandered congressional map without a statewide vote. [Read more](#)

Rural hospitals warn \$50B in grant funding won't offset looming federal cuts

Rural hospitals in Missouri say a \$50 billion federal investment in rural healthcare will be insufficient in offsetting upcoming reductions in federal Medicaid reimbursement that will put additional strain on already fragile rural healthcare systems across the state. [Read more](#)

Missouri lawmakers fail to pass AI regulations during 2026 legislative session

It's been a little over one week since Missouri's lawmakers called it quits for the year, but that doesn't mean they're all happy with what was accomplished, or what was not accomplished. [Read more](#)

County News



Google data center plan raises tax, transparency questions in rural Missouri

A \$5 million federal pandemic recovery grant helped Montgomery County prepare a rural industrial site along Interstate 70 for major development. Two years later, Amazon and Google are building data centers on nearly 2,000 acres near New Florence — and local officials are preparing to offer Google a 70% personal property tax abatement.

Google announced last week that it will invest \$15 billion in a data center south of the highway, joining an Amazon Data Services project already underway north of I-70. Supporters say the projects will bring construction jobs, permanent positions and millions in annual tax revenue to a county where many residents commute east for work. [Read more](#)

Moniteau County to put regulations on data centers

The Moniteau County Commission wants to get ahead of the data center issue. [Read more](#)

'Nodaway Says No': Residents attend meeting to discuss proposed AI Data Center

Over a hundred residents gathered in Nodaway County to learn more about a proposed hyperscale AI data center, with concerns ranging from cattle health, soil contamination, waste, health impacts and more. [Read more](#)

Boone County Commission votes to put jail sales tax on November ballot

The Boone County Commission on Tuesday voted unanimously to put a 3/8-cent sales tax on the November ballot. [Read more](#)

Local group looks to make Cole County 'workforce ready'

A group of locals have committed to tackling challenges to employment in Cole County, aiming to help the area become "a workforce-ready community." [Read more](#)

Share your county's achievements and honors

The Missouri Association of Counties would like you to Show Me Your County.

Show Me Your County is a chance for our counties to highlight a program, initiative or praise a hard-working county employee who has gone above and beyond their duties or has received an award.

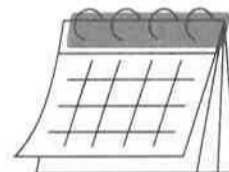
Counties can submit a 500-word or less description of the program, initiative or employee, along with pictures if applicable. Those submissions will then be featured on MAC's social media platforms and in the Missouri County Record magazine.

SHOW ME
YOUR COUNTY

Submit your county today

June

June 4 - MAC HR Training Day in Jefferson City
June 17 - Missouri Data Center Summit in Jefferson City
June 19 - State offices closed/Juneteenth



July

July 3 - State offices closed/Independence Day (observed)
July 14 - Last day for Governor to veto bills
July 17-20 - NACo Annual Conference

August

Aug. 4 - Official Election Day
Aug. 10-13 - Sheriffs' Summer Conference
Aug. 10-12 - MAC Summer Board Meeting
Aug. 28 - Bills become law
Aug. 31-Sept. 4 - Clerks' /Election Authorities' Annual Conference

Schedule of upcoming webinars for NACo members

NACo hosts several webinars for its members that cover a variety of different topics and programs for county government officials and their staff. Learn about the upcoming webinars and register to attend.

[View the webinars and register](#)



Boone County featured in a NACo webinar, "County strategies to support mental health and wellbeing across the lifespan"

Counties are on the front lines of supporting mental health and wellbeing—not only through clinical services, but by shaping the programs, partnerships and community conditions that help residents thrive. NACo and the Healthy Counties Innovation Council hosted a webinar exploring how counties are supporting mental health across the lifespan. This session highlighted practical, county-led approaches from Waukesha County, Wis., Clarendon County, S.C., and Boone County, Mo

[View the webinar](#)

NACo Annual Conference in New Orleans, July 17-20

The NACo Annual Conference is the premier gathering of elected and appointed officials from the nation's 3,069 counties, parishes and boroughs. The conference will include dozens of committee and caucus meetings, educational workshops, general sessions and more. Sessions will offer learning and best practices on the full range of county responsibilities and domestic policy issues. NACo membership will also elect new leadership and set the organization's policy priorities during the Annual Business Meeting.

[Register today](#)

NACo member running for 2nd VP is offering Datacenter webinar

Mike Turner, Vice Chair of the Loudoun County, VA Board of Supervisors, who also serves as the Chair of both the National Association of Counties (NACo) and the Virginia Association of Counties (VACo) Environment and Energy Land Use Committees is offering a free 60-minute webinar titled, "County Lessons Learned from 'Data Center Alley,' Loudoun County, VA."

Webinars will be held every Monday at 3 p.m. CDT and Thursday at 2 p.m. CDT until June 30

[Register for the webinar](#)

Registration is now open for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium

Join county leaders from across the country in the Texas Panhandle for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium, presented by the Rural Action Caucus in partnership with the NACo Rural Energy Academy. Held Sept. 23-25, 2026, this event will offer county officials a unique opportunity to engage with the most pressing energy issues shaping county land use decisions today.

[Register now](#)

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Missouri Association of Counties

PO Box 234

Jefferson City, MO 65102-0234

United States

573-634-2120 | www.mocounties.com

Sent from: info@mocounties.com

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